

Trimester 3 US History Study Guide

The exam will be on Wednesday 5/27.

You will be composing essay responses to the following questions on the exam. Below are **six** essay questions. Only **three** of the six will appear on the final exam.

1. Describe the circumstances leading to the Missouri Compromise of 1820 and its provisions regarding the admission of Missouri as a slave state and Maine as a free state. Analyze the impact of the compromise on the balance of power between free and slave states and its role in temporarily averting a crisis over the expansion of slavery.
2. Explore the underlying causes of tensions between the North and South in the decades leading up to the Civil War. Discuss issues such as slavery, states' rights, economic differences, and cultural divisions, and evaluate how these tensions contributed to the outbreak of the Civil War.
3. Trace the process of America's westward expansion in the 19th century, including the acquisition of new territories, conflicts with Native American tribes, and the settlement of the western frontier. Analyze the motivations behind westward expansion and its impact on Native American communities, the environment, and the nation as a whole.
4. Examine the significance of the Louisiana Purchase in 1803 and its impact on the growth and development of the United States. Discuss the reasons for President Thomas Jefferson's decision to acquire the Louisiana Territory from France and the consequences of the purchase for American expansion and national identity.
5. Explain the structure of the United States government as outlined in the Constitution, including the three branches of government and the system of checks and balances. Discuss the roles and responsibilities of each branch and how they interact to ensure a balance of power and prevent tyranny.
6. Explain the causes and effects of the Trail of Tears. In your response, describe the Indian Removal Act and Andrew Jackson's role in Native American removal. Then explain why the Five Civilized Tribes were forced to relocate to present-day Oklahoma and describe the hardships Native Americans faced during the Trail of Tears. Finally, explain how the Trail of Tears impacted Native Americans and the United States.